

Solubility

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- The limit or maximum amount of solute that will dissolve in a specified amount of solvent
- Typically expressed in g of solute per 100 mL of solvent (g/100mL)
- Values are temperature dependant. For example, the solubility of Na_2SO_4 at 0°C is 4.76g/100mL H_2O

Unsaturated Solution

- Solutions that are below the solubility limit

Saturated Solution

- Solutions that are exactly at the solubility limit

Supersaturated Solution

- Solutions that are *above* the solubility limit (in a "meta-stable" state)
- These solutions will quickly crystallize out if seeded (which is either accomplished by adding a small seed crystal or by scratching the side of a glass container)